

CLAIMING THE TOTAL CAPACITY FOR GREATNESS

Greetings, my very dearest, most beloved friends, brothers and sisters, sons and daughters. Again a working season draws toward its end. But each end is a beginning, as each beginning is also an end. These are the endless cycles, cycle upon cycle, the waves which constitute the infinite flow of the river of life. If you are within the flow, you grow and expand more and more into the universal oneness. If you stop the flow through your obstructions, you accumulate the force and the energy which then become blocks. Blocks are pain and suffering.

At each beginning and end of a working season I give an overall view, a map that gives something like a bird's eye view of the phase you have left behind, which then makes you ready for the phase to come. These maps give you a better understanding of the progression. No new phase could be possible without the preceding one. No step can be skipped. Year upon year of our cooperation, these maps have proven exact for most of you though some may be at the point of the respective phase right at the time we discuss it, while others may prepare and reach these points some months later. But that does not matter. There are always, of course, a few who fear and resist so much that they deliberately obstruct their progression, the natural organic movement, and are thus in unnecessary fear and pain. But on the whole, this is the way we work together.

You may remember that at the end of the last working season and at the beginning of this one, I announced that this past year, this winter in your terms, would be mostly dedicated to the beginning of "transforming work." That is, after your negativities have finally come to the surface and you have accepted and exposed them, fully taking responsibility, transformation of negative consciousness and energy becomes possible. I explained that the latter is quite impossible without the former. A vague and general awareness of your negative attitudes, destructive and evil intents does not suffice for the transformation work to take place. I said many times that first the negativities must be fully seen in all their details; the fear and shame of them must be overcome; the hiding and camouflaging must have stopped; the whitewashing as well as exaggerated self-blame must be relinquished. What is necessary is to simply and honestly own up to the full force of the devilish attitudes as well as to all their puny details. I told you again and again that only this will free you, but that this is by no means a morbid or self-negating process -- quite the contrary. Some of you may still wonder why so much emphasis on the negative is necessary for genuine spirituality to be reached. Some of you may even have tried other approaches, hoping to bypass this highly unpleasant task, but real solutions cannot be reached, nor can integration occur in those other ways.

The fruits of your hard work in this first unpleasant phase are beginning to be reaped. Quite a number of you have succeeded this past year, after all the arduous work with negative matter, to effect true transformation. The event of the Center has helped greatly in this particular aspect of the work.

Of course these phases are not strictly and exactly divided. They cannot be. They always overlap. In other words, you may already have removed the blocks to fully facing the negative aspects in one area and thus be ready for transformation work. At the same time, you may not yet have even begun to realize that there is grave distortion and destructiveness in other areas, untouched so far by your conscious awareness. In still other areas you have already gained full purification and are clear and free. This is why it is so difficult to judge whether total self-purification has been achieved or not. Only complete dedication, watchfulness, awareness, readiness to dismiss wishful thinking and pride will protect you from any kind of illusion -- illusion which must ultimately lead to painful disillusionment. The specific manner of this pathwork is a wonderful protection in this regard. The closeness you have developed; the intimate knowledge of yourselves you share with each other; the perceptiveness so many develop increasingly as a result of your progress; the greater honesty and courage that become gradually second nature -- all that is indispensable help. Last but not least, one of the most important gauges of this pathwork can constantly be used to determine your state: what is your life manifestation telling you? How rich and full is your life? How much joy, peace, and abundance is increasingly open to you? How much less are you afraid and reluctant to meet and expose the deepest regions of your innermost self? When you meet the inevitable inner blocks as momentary crisis, how fully do you "travel" through them to find yourself more fully you? These are the infallible answers (questions?) which, when honestly probed, will tell you the truth about whether or not you are stuck and deceive yourself about your progress -- perhaps because you hope that you can avoid facing and dealing with certain unpleasant inner material.

On the whole, all of you have traveled far since last year. You are now in a very different inner place, and you all know it. Many of you find yourselves for the first time connected in a way you never believed possible, and doubted could really exist, in spite of having given lip service to the words you have been hearing from me for years. Many of you believe truly and deeply for the first time that inner problems can indeed be fully resolved and the problematic self becomes healthy, whole, and renewed in a vital way. The number of friends reaching these stages increases steadily, and they help transmute the energies of new friends joining the pathwork. The momentum, the courage, the faith, the proof, the conviction, all these are vital ingredients that help, as well as others who witness what is happening to you, who bathe in your environment.

When you have reached these new stages you have never tasted before, although you may have heard them described, you also gain more courage to go deeper into still hidden layers of covert evil. There is always the spiral configuration: layer upon layer until the circles in the spiral become smaller and smaller. As they become smaller and gradually converge into one point, it all becomes increasingly simple. The simplicity at the final apex of the spiral is love. This simplicity means little when the ego's separation from the oneness. In that state, when the word "love" is used, it is either empty of feeling and experience, just a word, much bandied about, or worse, it is misused in pretending that what one speaks about is love when it is many other things that have little or nothing to do with real love. When you fully experience the inner meaning of love, everything is contained in that word.

To recapitulate briefly: previous phases dealt primarily with your ability to face negative attitudes, faults, distortions, destructiveness, impurities. Last year was the true beginning of transforming negative substance, negative matter, energy, and consciousness into the positive. And

both these aspects of the work will, of course, continue. But the second phase will become more and more possible, and this in turn will lead to the natural sequence of the progression which is to claim your own, to claim your full, total, unique self, to claim your hidden greatness. Tonight's topic will be about claiming what is truly yours.

It may seem peculiar, but it is a fact that human beings have a reluctance to truly let themselves be what they could be. An overgrown ego, of course, certainly makes its claims constantly, either overtly or covertly. But when it comes to your real greatness, you become very inhibited, ashamed, even afraid, and you hold back what you could be, what you sense you already are. What is this strange wall that holds you back from being who and what you are, from being your best, your greatest, most wise, generous, loving, creative, self-assertive, unfolding, aware, courageous, humble self with all its innate dignity and nobility? You are all of this -- and more. In addition, you have your own specific turn of mind, talent, and intelligence with which you have something utterly unique to contribute to life and creation. God manifests in and through you in a most special and individualized way, totally different from all others. I have recently given a lecture in which I outlined some typical manifestations of states and experiences in which the little self merges with the divine self. I also said that there are many other manifestations I would discuss at later periods. This is one of them. But what makes it apparently so difficult to claim your greatness?

Let us gain a better grip of the reasons, a deeper understanding, and therefore a greater motivation to give yourself the push you need to give yourself. When you become your full self in the best sense of the word, you are apparently two opposites at once. You are unique and special while at the same time you are not at all special, although unique. You are like everyone else. You are like everyone else in the sense that you are all divine manifestations. You all have fundamental divine qualities, and you also all have obstructions. They may vary in intensity and emphasis. You may differ in your development, in your openness and willingness to be in truth. But you all manifest as egos and must go through the same fundamental struggle to transcend this ego. But you are unique in the way God can manifest through you when you remove your obstructions, when you allow your specific greatness to come forth. Everyone is a genius, for everyone is God.

For the little ego who claims the ego specialness, this is not welcome news. The little ego wants to be above others, superior to all others. The Godself makes no such demands. What obstructs the real greatness from flowing forth is precisely the claim of the little ego who wants to tower above others; who needs the admiration of others; who wants to compare and compete with others and then subdue them and prove itself superior to all others. That is a particular evil that has to be ousted. This particular evil brings about many other attitudes which create shame, suffering, and many other destructive and evil patterns.

It may be well to say, "I only wish to be above because I feel so nothing." But how about trying to reverse this premise? Would you really feel to be nothing if you would not need to be so superior? I venture to say, no. Would you really become envious, jealous, petty, self-serving, spiteful, manipulative, malicious, not allowing others their own Godself -- in short, loveless -- if you would not wish to set yourself above others? Your God consciousness and the other person's God consciousness are never, never in a conflict. What is in conflict is only ego, only the separated state -- a state of blindness and limitation. The ego is not one, it is divided and is often in conflict and contradiction. God consciousness never is. The Godself never has to push for recognition. It recognizes itself and is sufficient unto itself.

Another obstruction toward the realization of your own ultimate unique beauty, greatness, genius is the fear of still existing inner evil. All fear is ultimately the fear of that. When the real nature of this fear is denied long enough and is projected outward onto other persons, outer events begin to manifest that seem to justify this fear of others. The nearer you come to transcending fear, the more you have to meet the self -- and the more you have to overcome the reluctance to do so. This fear creates a tremendous wall. The fear is a much greater obstruction than the evil itself. I said this many times. This kind of fear has very much to do with wanting to shine above others in the eyes of others. The claim of the little ego is, if it were to be translated into words, "Admire me, I am so much better than you. Love me for it." This, of course, is the ultimate folly.

The fear of evil within is superfluous because the evil is distorted beauty and love. The devil that resides in everyone was initially an angel. How can you confront this devil? As I said before, all of you have made substantial progress in this respect. You reveal, you expose, you admit, you acknowledge, you take responsibility to ever greater degree. This is why transformation and resolving of deepest, most persistent problems indeed occurs with ever greater frequency in a most substantial and real way. But wherever there is still fear, the ego-pride is always partially responsible for it, and the ego-pride is connected to your ignorance of the nature of the devil in you. Not only do you believe that this is the final, real you, but you also believe that this devilish part of the self is intrinsically foreign and other than divine. This ignorance adds to the chasm, it widens the gap in the mind.

I would like to invite you now, my friends, to make room in your consciousness to the idea that this very same devil with all its cruelty, malice, dishonesty, pettiness, hate, and fear is essentially an angel. Allegorically and symbolically, Lucifer was originally an angel of light. He has turned into Satan, and it is the evolutionary task of all separated entities to bring about a retransformation from Satan to Lucifer, from the darkness back to light. This is an inner process that takes place within your psyche, my friends.

The devil is your fear. The fear is the guilt for the hateful, malicious, cruel ways of the mind, the feelings, and therefore always in some way also expressed in action. Only when this guilt is faced, when the pain of it is fully experienced, not rejected, but "traveled through," can guilt and fear dissolve. Then the angel reveals itself. Then you are infused with warmth, love, confidence, soft flow, joy, and creative expansion. When this process takes place again and again until all evil matter is transformed, you will no longer believe that you give up anything when you struggle with your mind to hold onto being negative. The illusion is that you lose something. I often said that so much energy is trapped in the evil, an energy that you do not wish to lack even though you do your utmost to squash and deny it in its present state. When you go through the process of genuine transcendence of evil, you gain all the forceful vitality back that you had to inactivate in order to avoid the evil. You will not only lose nothing, but the gain will be enormous.

If you can all learn to open wide your arms, your consciousness, your willingness to the devil in you in faith and fearless confidence in the inner guidance, you will dispel all fear -- in reality, not in the illusion of escaping and cheating. You do not overcome, you do not oust or separate yourself from anything in you. You meet it full face. Then it will dissolve, and its original nature will be revealed. Fully embrace this devil in the idea -- to begin with, the idea -- the devil is an angel. The power and the vitality of this devil can indeed, by your own turn of mind and of consciousness,

become a glowing light force of beautiful creative verve, love, and energy, of supreme wisdom. The puny, jealous, separative consciousness of the devil, constantly embattled against the beautiful laws of life, will spread wide open. And I say to you: the stronger the devil, the stronger your angel. For the strength is the same in essence. If you allow this thought to take root in you, you will fear much less. You will be less inclined to still hide and whitewash and be a-tremble of your own evil or devil.

Approach it with the ultimate of courage and faith. Crystallize in that way the beautiful angel that this devil harbors in essence. This is the transforming work that will take place in ever increasing measure. No one can claim his birthright, his genius, his unique contribution to life who does not fearlessly meet the devil in him and expose it.

Only in that way can you conciliate the opposites, the dualities. Each duality, each mutually exclusive opposite you meet as an obstruction is a sign that you are still divided. You are split off from something in your deeper consciousness. You are split off in fear, in pride, in self-will, in ignorance, in greed, in hate. Those very same aspects can be totally reversed. The fear will become faith and trust. The pride will become humility. The self-will will become a supple, resilient, flexible giving-in, going-with attitude, a finely attuned lack of rigidity to flow with your rhythm of life and not ever stem against it. The ignorance will become awareness, perception, understanding, and wisdom. The greed will become a special kind of trust that will make you reach out and know that there is abundance for you in every way. And you will have abundance so that greed will be ludicrous. The hate will become your power of love.

No human being, no individual, no entity can ever find peace and inner fulfillment, joy, wholeness, security, and his intrinsic genius with which he uniquely contributes to creation unless he can be dedicated to a cause outside himself. This must not be a therapeutic ploy. You must not force yourself in a dutiful way to now be dedicated and selfless in order to gain these desirable rewards of glowing health and fulfilled living. But it is something you ought to clearly understand and use as yet another signpost to where you are. You should honestly admit, once again, if you still see the ultimate of life's fulfillment as a totally selfish and self-serving enterprise in which everything is supposed to be geared around you so as to suit you. If you explore your fantasies in this respect, you will see exactly where you are. It is very important that here, like in all other matters, you be completely honest. And if you see that there is no genuine desire in you as yet to serve a larger cause, to forget the little self-interest, at least some of the time, for the sake of larger issues, then you should understand your loneliness, your disconnectedness, your fear and guilt, and your inability to realize your talents. You must know that you have the innate capacity in you to be self-forgetful but that your little ego thwarts this natural state. Maybe you hold onto misconceptions that will prevent you from wanting to go beyond yourself. Perhaps you believe that dedication to a cause beyond your little ego implies masochistic suffering and deprivation, poverty, and frustration of personal fulfillment and needs. As a matter of fact it is just the other way round. Only when you can truly give to creation of your unique contribution in a selfless spirit, can you also feel entitled to receive, to be fulfilled, to have abundance in all ways. If you feel inhibited and reluctant to claim this full self-expression, it would be good if you were to look at your selfishness, your lack of interest to add to the universe. You may conceal this under a pseudo-selflessness which may in fact be more selfish than overt selfishness. It may be part of your mask, your need to appear good in the eyes of others.

Many of you have begun to be dedicated to a greater cause outside yourself. This comes out of an organic process that developed as you faced your little ego with all its self-serving opportunism

and vanity. You naturally grew into a more developed state, and you now feel that wonderful fulfillment that arises from serving a spiritual cause, from giving to creation. You may not have specifically connected your increased peace, joy, liberation, creativeness with the fact that you are so much more interested in giving something of yourself to this cause of helping more and more souls to purify themselves and reach higher states of inner truth. Maybe by making this connection now, you will be further encouraged in the right direction.

Once again we have a vicious circle, respectively a benign circle. When you stay afraid and in hiding of the inner evil, you cannot claim your total, wonderful, egoless self. You stay selfish and therefore only concerned in a negative way with the interests of the little ego, with puny advantages, and unwilling to give to life. Thus you become more and more impoverished. Therefore you become unhappy and embittered and feel more justified to withhold and give nothing, and the vicious circle continues.

But as you transform this vicious circle into a benign one, almost inadvertently by itself, as it were, you are naturally led from within to an attitude of selfless giving. This is never a sentimental giving in to neurotic and unhealthy demands of others. It means true giving in the best sense. By giving to others, you cannot escape giving to the self. For in reality, as you find out increasingly, there can be no other attitude to the self than to others and vice versa. Thus giving to a cause beyond the little self is the greatest self-enrichment imaginable. But, as I cannot sufficiently stress, no matter how much you pretend and feign even to the point of making yourself believe that your giving is genuine, life cannot be cheated. Your life speaks the truth to you about this, as in all other matters.

He who deprives himself of the supreme satisfaction of giving to a cause beyond the little ego and the little self-interests cannot know peace, joy, fulfillment, self-esteem, and the deep sense of being deserving of the best that life has to offer. There is an exact correlation: to the degree you offer generously and trustingly the best you have to give to life, allowing God to take over, to that very same degree will you feel perfectly entitled to spread your arms wide to receive the best life has to offer. To the degree you hold back in puny fear that this might damage your self-interest, to that same degree you must hold back from receiving life's riches. There can be no mistake in this calculation. There is this finely calibrated mechanism installed in the deepest regions of your psyche that works in absolute perfection.

When your giving to life becomes so whole that you are deeply willing to forego the little vanities for appearance's sake, for the sake of the greater truth in a sense of responsibility that this is necessary, then the abundance of your life will surpass your present understanding.

When this group came together, you were all separated islands, each one concerned with his own little suffering, completely walled off from your inner self and consequently, of course, also from each other and from life. You were then totally unwilling to give to life. Only recently do many of you find that this still holds true to some extent. But you make this discovery as you are already devoted to giving of yourself to a cause beyond. You are all engaged in the most noble cause there could be for an entity to be active in, and that is the purification, the healing of souls. In that way you contribute in the most vital way possible to the great evolutionary plan.

Every single soul who comes nearer to the threshold and finally passes this threshold releases untold energies of beauty, of wisdom, of strength, of love, of truth, of creative resourcefulness, of oneness, and thus affects so many zillions of other entities. This happens directly and indirectly. Just try to figure out mathematically how each changed attitude in you profits those around you. Each attitude of constructive giving is an immense, beautiful, and vital living force in the universal scheme, affecting endlessly what is. I once gave an analogy. If an object is thrown into water, waves form in circles spreading wider and wider. These waves never end. They only seem to end where the body of water ends. But if the body of water were as endless as the universe, these waves would never end. So each idea, intent, and thought you form; motivated by unselfish devotion to universal truth, love, faith; expressing a desire to contribute to life according to the will of the All-Consciousness that permeates all life, is an endless wave that never never ceases, that has its effects long after you have lost any remote inkling of it in your conscious mind. You activate new creation, you set new psychic events in motion which have an inexorable effect on life and you.

It is therefore of utmost importance that you know what tremendous effects your thinking and your intentionality have, the positive as well as the negative. Your loving thoughts to the universe, your surrender to the divine creative intelligence in you is as real and effective as your spiteful withholding in lack of trust.

The venture you are now engaged in gives you a wonderful opportunity to help others. The very work of purification you do must in some sense be transmitted to others. Your giving can take many forms. It will be in your own unique way. Your inner creative intelligence must make the decision for you, and only you know how you are best suited to contribute. What you can determine with your conscious mind is the intent, the wish to surrender your will, the desire to activate that in you which is greater than your ego in order to increase the strength of your group, in order to add to the light it already is. The more honest you are in this respect, the clearer the muddy waters will become. The obscurity, the opaqueness will diminish. To the degree you can honestly know your self-servingness, you are a step nearer to truly selfless giving.

The reason you cannot claim your greatness is precisely because of the little self that is constantly on the lookout to gain its own little advantages. These advantages may be material, or they may be the pride to show off and gain admiration from others, to appear better in the eyes of others than you secretly believe you are. But when you free yourself of this attitude, it will be infinitely easier for you to claim your true self with all its capacities, potentialities, and uniqueness. You will allow yourself all the abundance that you now may have only in limited ways and at the price of guilt. You will be appreciated just because this is no longer your aim. You will no longer be ashamed of being the best you can be. The holding back from being your best will stop to the degree you uproot the pride of the little ego, the stingy withholding from life, the spiteful non-givingness, the self-servingness of the little ego, the hypocrisy and hiding of the true state, the fear of the evil inside because you ignore that the evil contains the essence of the angel. Within every devil slumbers the angel, only to want out.

If you lack humility, you cannot allow your greatness to come forth. But in humbleness, there will be no need to hold back your greatness. There will be no pushing and no proving. It will be a quiet inner knowing. It is then entirely unimportant and unnecessary that others recognize you. They will come to recognize you when you no longer need it and insist upon it. But as long as this

recognition is necessary, it is the little ego who loses its sense of proportion, who does not possess a sense of proportion or reality. It is groping in the dark, and it fights in the wrong direction.

So I say to you, my friends, as this series of lectures draws to its conclusion (which does not mean, of course, an interruption of our contact now that your Center offers such wonderful opportunity for work), that perhaps you can visualize for yourself a new state of greatness in humility, without ego, without proving anything, without comparing yourself positively or negatively with others. Visualize yourself unafraid of the worst in you because the worst will transform into the most beautiful, wise, strong, loving force. In the hiding, it becomes puny and dangerous. In the exposing, you make it possible to envisage this new potential.

In the next question-and-answer session many important things will be discussed. Prepare your questions about the two topics you wish to ask my advice on (approach to children's upbringing and the prospect of making a sanctuary for animals and plant life in the Center). The answers will be important beyond the present scope.

I bless you now and tell you once again that your work and your growth is an ever increasing beautiful energy form in the spiritual world. If you could see the beauty, you would be astounded. If you could truly perceive the value, the importance, and the significance of what each one of you is doing, you would know a deep, deep joy.

And you will know this, sooner or later, even while you are still in the body. You will first sense it, you will perceive it, you will inwardly experience it, and it will make you stronger and more responsible. All of you will become more conscious instruments, each in your own way, each in your one, beautiful, perfect way, each being a little piece that completes the whole and fits exactly together with the other "pieces." One is not being able to function without the other, each having its own unique contribution, and therefore no need for jealousy or self-proving is ever necessary. Only when you know that, will you also know your unique greatness, your total beauty and wisdom.

Love permeates all your undertakings, every step of the way is meaningful and significant in your life. And your life is very, very valuable. You are all blessed. Be in peace!

For information to find and participate in Pathwork activities world wide, please write:

The Pathwork® Foundation
PO Box 6010
Charlottesville, VA 22906-6010, USA
Call: 1-800-PATHWORK, or
Visit: www.pathwork.org

The following notices are for your guidance in the use of the Pathwork® name and this lecture material.

Trademark/Service Mark

Pathwork® is a registered service mark owned by The Pathwork Foundation, and may not be used without the express written permission of the Foundation. The Foundation may, in its sole discretion, authorize use of the Pathwork® mark by other organizations or persons, such as affiliate organizations and chapters.

Copyright

The copyright of the Pathwork Guide material is the sole property of The Pathwork Foundation. This lecture may be reproduced, in compliance with the Foundation Trademark, Service Mark and Copyright Policy, but the text may not be altered or abbreviated in any way, nor may the copyright, trademark, service mark, or any other notices be removed. Recipients may be charged the cost of reproduction and distribution only.

Any person or organization using The Pathwork Foundation service mark or copyrighted material is deemed to have agreed to comply with the Foundation Trademark, Service Mark and Copyright Policy. To obtain information or a copy of this policy, please contact the Foundation.